

Community

Follow our thriving communities on facebook, twitter and our forum and you just might get featured here

**Livin' it up**

Carlos Spottorno captures intimate images of the insanely wealthy.
<http://digit.in/1ITkWC5>

Mass Movement

Advancements in transport have made the world a much smaller place, but for super-massive objects, transport is still no easy task. Here are some of the most capable heavy-lift machines ever made.

**Mighty Marlin**

Blue Marlin and Black Marlin are two of the largest transport ships in the world. Weighing in at 74,000 tonnes, fully loaded, these ships can carry everything from other ships to full-fledged oil-derricks between themselves. A 17,600BHP engine is required to get each of these monsters moving, and even then, they can only hit 14 knots.

Crawler-Transporter

Transporting the Saturn V rocket to its launch pad, not to mention the massive Space Shuttles and their launch towers is no easy feat. The platform that carries these behemoths is possibly the largest tracked vehicle in the world and has a carrying capacity of 5500 tonnes. The platform itself weighs over 2000 tonnes and each track's shoe alone weighs 900kg.

**Seawise Giant**

Take a wild guess, what do you think the largest self-propelled man-made object weighs? 100,000 tonnes? 200,000? Nope. 650,000 tonnes. That's the weight of the Seawise Giant, also considered to be the largest ship ever built. This ocean-going monster was sunk in the Iran-Iraq war, but was later salvaged and pushed back into service.

**Antonov An-225 "Mriya"**

The American's and the French might claim to build the best aircraft, but this side of the Iron Curtain, they stand no chance against the Russians. The Antonov An-225 holds the record for transporting the largest payload ever loaded into an aircraft (at 200+ tonnes). This aircraft is so large that it makes the Boeing 747 look like a Cessna.

Caterpillar 797

If you thought that pesky container truck that almost ran you over on the highway was large, you've seen nothing yet. The Caterpillar 797 is so massive that the wheel costs more than a Hyundai Jazz and the driver has to climb 15m to get to the driving compartment. If that wasn't enough, this 400 tonne metal monster can travel at 42kph!

**Thialf (Greyjoy?)**

Lost an oil-derrick? The Thialf will fish it out for you. This semi-submerged crane has a lifting capacity of 14,500 tonnes, more than enough for those derricks you keep losing. The vessel itself is held in position by six 5,500KW motors and 12 anchors that weigh 22.5 tonnes each. Random fact, it's got double the lifting capacity of its nearest competitor.